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Graduate Recruitment Team

Capula Investment Management LLP

London

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Analyst Programme in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Capula's launch of a systematic commodities fund in 2026, its first major move beyond fixed income, overlaps directly with my own commodity research.

My work keeps returning to one question: does an apparent edge survive a proper test? I tested CAPM on 694 anomaly portfolios across 54 countries and rejected zero alpha jointly in 48 of 53, with momentum the most persistent anomaly. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, estimates petro-currencies' oil betas from OPEC announcement-day surprises, tests whether Norway's krone conversions, Russia's 2017–22 budget rule and Mexico's put hedge make them smaller, kinked or one-sided, and asks whether any beta that remains survives costs and a White reality check. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, I also built a wheat calendar-spread strategy whose weekly backtest returned a Sharpe ratio of 0.76 before costs and 0.28 after, which taught me how quickly turnover erodes an edge.

Hedge funds appeal to me because the distance between an idea and its consequences is short: a research view becomes a position, and the position is marked every day. I take that accountability seriously. As Vice-President and then President of the Strathclyde Poker Society, I taught new members to use the Kelly criterion to work out how many buy-ins their win rate, variance and risk tolerance call for, with a buffer because their edge is only an estimate; a position sized on an uncertain alpha needs the same caution. As Treasurer of the Agricapital Society, which I helped grow to 126 members, I manage its budget and accounts.

Capula stands out to me because it is extending a rigorous, quantitative approach from bonds and currencies into raw materials: its new Capula Alternative Markets Alpha Fund trades commodities algorithmically, with room for \$2 billion to \$3 billion of capital. My dissertation sits on that same bridge between currencies and commodities and asks whether an apparent edge there survives a realistic trading test, so I would like to learn how a firm with Capula's discipline turns that kind of research into risk across its trading functions.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan